



Samsung new VR headset

Samsung's upcoming VR headset, dubbed HMD Odyssey+ made its first appearance on the FCC's database. <https://digit.in/sep18-42-1>



NASA asteroid sampling craft

NASA's asteroid-sampling spacecraft, OSIRIS-REx, has captured its very first images of its deep-space target, Benu. <https://digit.in/sep18-42-2>

Wooting One

Display title: First of a kind

Price
₹11,600



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ll the major keyboard manufacturers use digital signal as input in their keyboards.

Wooting is the first to do so in mechanical keyboards. The Wooting One can communicate with the computer using both analog and digital signals.

In analog mode, it becomes possible to accept more than just an on and off signal. This brings a paradigm shift in playing games with the keyboard. Due to this single feature, the keyboard opens itself up to numerous possibilities for features that can be implemented in the future.

The Wooting One comes with full N-key rollover and it will register all the key presses without any problem. Multimedia functionality can be controlled using modifier keys and you can also control the brightness levels. A dedicated Mode key can be used to switch between digital and analog modes. The arrow keys (left, down and right) along with the Fn key can be used to switch between the three analog modes.

You will receive several accessories in the box. Apart from the quick start guide, you get extra switches, screws and a keycap/switch puller. Eight Flaretech switches are provided where four of them are the Linear55 "Red" switches while the rest are Clicky55 "Blue". These are optical switches that use infrared red light to register



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inputs. The Red switch is actually clear while the Blue switch has Orange on the inside. Our variant had the Linear55 "Red" switches. Both the switches have an operating force of 55g and a lifespan of 100 million keystrokes, twice the amount of Cherry MX mechanical

switches.

The Wootility software enables you to control the various aspects of analog input coming from every key press. The user-interface of Wootility is absolutely brilliant. We can even go on to say that the lighting control is by far the simplest we've seen on any keyboard utility software. It lacks macro recording functionality, though. However, the Wootility software offers powerful control over the analog settings such as the variable actuation distance and customisable analog curve. This is their primary focus and they have implemented it quite well in a simple interface. Another feature is double keystroke (DKS) that enables you to assign two different keystrokes to a single key at different depths. Key combinations can also be assigned at different depths.

We primarily put the keyboard to test in CS:GO, Need for Speed: Most Wanted 2012, and Rocket League. In CS:GO, you will be able to control the movement using analog input. However, you will have to tweak the analog curve from the software according to

your preferences to hit the comfortable spot. You might also come across limitations on a few shooting games that don't support a controller and mouse simultaneously. You will be able to move but you won't be able to aim with your mouse.

Not to forget, there's also a big learning curve to get used to analog control on a keyboard. For almost all your life, you must have been using keyboards with digital input, and because of this muscle memory, it will take some time to be familiar with analog control. The biggest shortcoming is that the keyboard will still be detected as an Xbox 360 controller and not an analog keyboard. Since the concept of an analog keyboard is new, games don't really have native support for these keyboards yet. The only way for it to happen is adoption of this technology by big video game developers and studios eventually.

A mechanical keyboard with analog input might sound incredible for keyboard enthusiasts. However, for regular users, it doesn't really mean anything unless they experience it first. The Wooting One can cater to both. If the analog input is taken out of the picture, the keyboard works brilliantly in its normal digital mode as well. But you shouldn't be buying a Wooting keyboard in the first place if you aren't going to use the analog mode. Being tenkeyless, it could be a deal-breaker for many but fret not, they are coming out with the Wooting Two. This one is going to be a standard-size keyboard with a numpad. Coming back to the Wooting One, they don't officially sell in India yet. If you wish to buy one then you'd have to opt for their own online store and bear a hefty international shipping charges.

—Abhijit Dey

SPECIFICATIONS

KEYBOARD SIZE: Tenkeyless | KEYBOARD BACKLIGHTING: RGB LED | SWITCH TYPE: Optical (Flaretech Linear55 "Red" 100-million lifecycle) | POLLING RATE: 1000 Hz (1 ms) | KEY-ROLLOVER: N-key rollover | INTERFACE: USB 2.0 | DIMENSIONS: Width - 43.4 cm, Depth - 16.8 cm, Height - 3.9 cm | WEIGHT: 800 g

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